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POLICY NUMBER: FP-OPSFIN-111

General Cashiering

This policy details the Hotel requirements for managing and controlling cash and checks.

POLICY STATEMENT

This policy includes required guidelines for managing and controlling cash and checks at the Hotel.

APPLICABILITY

All Owned & Operated Hotels (including Shared Service Centers supporting these hotels).

EXCLUSIONS/EXCEPTIONS

No exclusions.

A. CASH CLOSE-OUT GUIDELINES

Under no circumstances is a Hotel to accept cash or check and not record it in the Property Management System (PMS) or Point of Sale System (POS), irrespective of the currency received.

- 1) Team Members are required to reconcile their own daily takings/deposits to the Property Management System (PMS) or Point of Sale System (POS) at the end of each shift as part of the drop process. The reconciliation is to be performed in a safe location, ideally in an area not open to guests and with minimum distractions.
- 2) If the Team Member has a house fund, they must first count and separate out this amount. All remaining funds must be dropped. If there is a shortage to the house fund amount, a due back must be processed.
- 3) If the Team Member does not have a house fund, all monies are counted and reconciled to the Cashier report from the relevant PMS or POS, and then dropped without the system close-out report.
- 4) Foreign Currency must always be dropped at the end of the shift and should not be held as part of the Team Member's house funds. Where applicable, Team Member's should refer to SOP #132 FD Handling Currency Exchange and OnQ Best Practice #1047.
- 5) All shift drops (cash, checks, due backs, etc.) must be documented on the drop log and witnessed in writing by an independent Team Member and placed in the drop safe. It is the responsibility of the Team Member dropping and the witness to ensure that the drop was successfully deposited in the drop safe.
- 6) The format of the drop log may vary from hotel to hotel; however, at a minimum the drop log must contain the following:
 - a. Team Member name
 - b. Team Member signature
 - c. Witness name
 - d. Witness signature
 - e. Amount in envelope
 - f. Date and time of drop
 - g. General Cashier name, signature, and date (upon collection of the drops)
 - h. Witness name, signature, and date (upon collection of the drops)
 - i. Total number of envelopes picked up (upon collection of the drops)

B. DROP SAFE GUIDELINES

- 1) The drop safe must be emptied every business day that the General Cashier, or equivalent, is working. The emptying of the drop safe is to be carried out by the General Cashier, or equivalent, with a witness present.
- 2) Access to the drop safe will be controlled to ensure that two individuals (General Cashier and witness) must be present to open the safe (e.g., with 2 keys, key / combination, split combination, etc.).
- 3) The role of the witness is to confirm the number of envelopes removed from the drop safe. The witness is not required to confirm that the amount inside the envelopes agrees with what is written on the envelope.
- 4) Both the General Cashier, or equivalent, and witness are required to reconcile the number of envelopes collected to the number of envelopes listed on the drop log. The General Cashier and witness must indicate the number of envelopes collected and both must sign and date the drop log.
- 5) The General Cashier, or equivalent, should be accompanied back to the General Cashier's office. Ideally this should be with a member of the Security department.

C. DROP SAFE COUNT

- 1) The General Cashier, or equivalent, is required to count the contents of the drop envelopes and reconcile these amounts back to the drop log. This includes completing the application sections of the General Cashier Report (GCR).
- 2) The General Cashier must not have access to the relevant PMS or POS readings; the daily drop count must be blind. Due to staffing restrictions in some properties (i.e., Centralized, Focused Service, etc.) or if the Hotel uses a cash machine, the blind drop requirement for the General Cashier may not be required.
- 3) If the General Cashier has more than one day's takings/drops, (i.e., a day after the weekend or public holiday), a count and General Cashier Report must still be completed for each day.
- 4) Material discrepancies (amount to be determined at the discretion of the Finance Leader or Operations Leader but in no case greater than \$50 USD) between the drop log amount and the actual envelope contents must be highlighted and immediately investigated.
- 5) A separate deposit slip is to be completed for each day's total monies and a separate container/tamper proof bag must be made for each day's deposits. Each deposit container/tamper proof bag must be logged and signed for separately by the armored car service/professional security firm.
- 6) Another deposit slip must be completed for any foreign currency deposits. At a minimum, foreign currency must be deposited once per month.

D. BANK DEPOSIT COLLECTION

- 1) Monies must be collected from the Hotel by a professional security firm and/or the bank directly. Identification of the employees from the professional security firm / bank should be checked upon each collection, prior to handing over the daily deposit. Each region and security firm / bank may have their own deposit handling procedures and they should be followed by the Hotel.
- 2) The professional security firm / bank pickup must occur at least once per week. However, the Hotel should increase the frequency if deemed necessary based on cash volumes and other operational needs.

E. CHANGE ORDERS

- 1) Change orders with the bank must be documented in writing.
- 2) The Finance Leader (or designee) or Operations Leader must approve all change order requests prior to requesting funds from the bank and ensure the prior change order has been recorded and re-banked. Once approval is obtained, the General Cashier must prepare the change order deposit. The change order transaction must be recorded on the General Ledger.
- 3) The General Cashier cannot request the funds from the bank directly.
- 4) When the change order amount is received (typically by the General Cashier or equivalent) it must be posted to the General Ledger. The amount received and deposited must be equal.

F. CASH JOURNAL

- 1) All cash journals must be posted prior to month-end close and there should be one completed GCR per calendar day. In order to maintain proper segregation of duties the cash journal must not be posted by the General Cashier (i.e., they must not have posting rights in the General Ledger).
- 2) All overages and shortages identified as part of the GCR, must be investigated and resolved. The direct supervisor / manager of the Team Member with the over or short must be informed immediately after a discrepancy is discovered. The over / short needs be clearly identified on the GCR and any appropriate back-up / explanation is to be included with the cash journal documentation.
- 3) Cash journal practices may vary depending on the Shared Service environment.

G. CASH MACHINE GUIDANCE

Hotels with Cash Machines are required to comply with the following at a minimum:

- 1) Two Team Members are required to open the Cash Machine at all times.
- 2) Team Members are not required to manually count their cash if the Cash Machine is able to perform and record the count in the form of a printed receipt. However, Team Members are still required to reconcile the count back to the system Cashier Report from the relevant PMS or POS.
- 3) Dropping cash into the Cash Machine does not require a witness or a drop log, provided that the Cash Machine is able to record the transaction in the form of a printed receipt. The receipt must at a minimum include the following:
 - a. Team Member name or unique account number assigned to an individual Team Member
 - b. Amount of drop
 - c. Date & time of drop
- 4) The emptying of the Cash Machine should be conducted every business day that the General Cashier is working, except for Hotels with professional security firms / banks which collect cash directly from the machine. In this case, Section D of this policy still applies.

DEFINITIONS	
TERM/ACRONYM	DEFINITION
Drop Safe	The hotel's safe where Team Members can drop their daily takings / deposit of cash, checks, and/or due backs.
Due Back	Sometimes called a "due me". Occurs when a Team Member has insufficient takings (received cash) to complete a transaction such as a paid out, currency exchange, or tip pay out. Typically, a due back is used to bring a Team Member's issued house bank back to its original amount and/or to pay monies due to a Team Member when they are owed cash for tips as required under local law or a collective bargaining agreement.
Finance Leader	Ranking Accounting / Finance representative for the property (i.e., DOF, Controller, or Finance Manager).
General Cashier Report	The "GCR" is a report which tallies per Team Member their cash active recorded in the system, amount of monies or due back dropped by the Team Member, and shows the variance between the amount recorded and the amount dropped.
House Funds	Also known as "Floats" or "Banks". This is a set amount of money issued to a Team Member to be used in the normal course of hotel operations.
Regional Finance Director	Regional Team Member responsible for the Accounting/Finance functions of a set of Hotels. Property Finance Leader has a direct or indirect reporting relationship to this individual.